



Final Cut Pro is one of the more formidable applications for the Mac, and one of the reasons you should switch if you need to edit video.

If you've got the necessary Mac hardware (we're talking about the higher-end iMacs and Mac Pros here), you can enjoy FCP's real-time effects—pull down frame-rates, adjust image quality, and a whole lot more. It bundles LiveType 2, an application dedicated to creating dynamic, animated titles for your movies.

Unfortunately, you can't download a demo of Final Cut Pro—it comes for a painful \$1,299 (Rs 52,000), not to mention the price of a Mac to run it—of course, this makes sense only for a big movie studio. For low-budget video editing, you can get Final Cut Express for \$299 (Rs 12,000).

Adobe Creative Suite 3 (CS3)

With CS3, Adobe returned to the Mac with a vengeance—while previous versions were better on Windows, CS3 has been optimised for the Mac.

The Mac version of Photoshop CS3, for example, runs 40 per cent faster than Photoshop CS2 (on Intel Macs)!